Changing page margins

Page margins are the white space around the top, bottom, left, and right of your document. Margins let Writer know where to start placing the text at the top of a document, when to move on to the next page at the bottom, where to start typing text on the left side, and where to stop and move to the next line on the right.

Changing or setting page margins in OpenOffice writer can be done in two ways:

1. Using the **Rulers**—quick and easy, but does not have precise values.
2. Using the **Page Style** dialog box—can specify precise values for the margins.

Changing page margins - using Ruler

1. The shaded sections of the rulers are the margins.
2. Hold the mouse pointer over the line between the gray and white sections.
3. The mouse pointer turns into a double-headed arrow.
4. Hold down the left mouse button and drag the mouse to move the margin and release it at the required point.
5. The new margin is set.

Using Page Style dialog box

To change margins using the Page Style dialog box

1. **Right-click** anywhere on the page and select Page from the popup menu or select page tab of Page **Style dialog box** as shown in Figure 6.23.
2. In the **Margins** group, specify the values for left , right , top and bottom margins.
3. Click on ok button.

6.9.2 Orientation

Page orientation refers to how the document will be displayed on screen and printed. There are two different orientations:

Landscape - The width of the document is more than the height. This is best suited for displaying table, professional photos, invitations, album etc.

Portrait – This is the most common and default orientation. Here, the height of the document is more than the width. Normally books, newspapers will be displayed in this format.

To change the orientation:

- Select the page whose orientation is to be changed
- In the **Page style** dialog box, under the **Orientation** group,
- Select **Portrait** or **Landscape** button.

6.9.3 Page colour and borders

Changing the page color is not quite common. To do so, in the **Page style** dialog box , in the **Background** option, click on **color** and select the **"color"** from the color palette or select **"graphic"** to apply an image as a page background, it, as shown in Figure 6.24.

Borders can be applied to an entire document, an entire page, paragraph, or just to certain sections of the document. From the Page Style dialog box , select the Border tab, the **user defined area** helps to define the area of borders, the line style of borders, color of borders Figure 6.25 shows the borders setting in the Page Style dialog box.